

Sony's Cinema Shot

In conversation with Mr. Mukesh Srivastava, Head of Business - Digital Imaging, Sony India, on the company's new cinema line of FX30 cameras and what makes them so special

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Sony recently launched a new Cinema Line camera in India, dubbed the FX30. In the wake of the launch we got the opportunity to ask Mr. Mukesh Srivastava, Head of Business - Digital Imaging, Sony India some questions regarding the new camera itself, the Indian market's attitude towards Cinema Line cameras and Sony's unique R&D process of creating a new camera. Edited excerpts follow:

Q What makes the cinema line of cameras from Sony so different from the other video centric cameras like the Sony A7S series?

A In the last couple of years, we have seen a tremendous rise in video content creation with huge demand for cameras that have cinematic features. Sony Cinema Line cameras are designed for filmmakers keeping in mind the features specific to movie shooting. Special attention has been paid to all areas including body design, durability, high functionality and battery life.

As compared to the Alpha range, Cinema Line cameras come with the functionality of multiple screw holes on the body and handle, allowing accessories to be attached directly. The camera body is compact, lightweight and modular, giving the flexibility to grab and shoot. These cameras come with S-Cinetone. S-Cinetone is designed to quickly create richer-looking final content with ease, without expensive post-production.



Mr. Mukesh Srivastava
Head of Business - Digital Imaging,
Sony India

Q What kind of market and target audience does a camera like the FX30 have in India?

A In recent years, we have seen a major shift in consumer behaviour from mainstream filmmaking to OTT, regional cinema, YouTube and regional OTT. Viewers are turning towards flexible video platforms to stream content on demand. Travel has also resumed and the number of weddings is at an all-time high. This has increased the demand for video-oriented cameras with strong cinematic capabilities for wedding filmmaking. The camera is made for young content creators and filmmakers. It has two variants – ILME-FX30 which comes with an XLR handle for handheld shooting and ILME-FX30B which is only body. Compact and light in weight, the

FX30 can be operated in combination with gimbals and drones or with a variety of attached equipment. It is designed to withstand long shoots, with sturdy construction suited to harsh conditions. FX30 features a distinctive flat-top design that makes it versatile. The grip has been designed keeping extended handheld shooting sessions in mind. It features an innovative heat dissipation structure for uninterrupted 4K/120p recording, reliable power for extended recording and a durable magnesium alloy chassis. We are continuously working on technology that encompasses the needs of the next-gen filmmakers and creators.

Q In which sector of the Indian market do you see the maximum growth potential in the next 5 years? The amateur/enthusiast segment? The semi-professional/professional segment? Or the cinema-level segment? And why?

The rate at which Indians are consuming video content is at an all-time high, establishing the potential of the market for Sony. OTT, vlogging, regional content and short films are some of the latest trends which are creating exciting opportunities for this market. Driven by the rising penetration of smartphones, smart televisions and with a multitude of streaming platform accessibility, the video segment is bound to grow exponentially. The post-pandemic era is also seeing a major rise in blockbuster movies which are making a comeback in theatres. What started as a YouTube channel out of curiosity is turning into a major profession for content creators. This has translated into a growing demand from content creators and vloggers for advanced imaging technology with easy-to-use functionalities to capture great-looking videos and versatile content without a tricky setup. We make sure that our innovation reaches our audience before time so that we lead them into exciting surprises of technology embedded with artificial intelligence on a digital canvas. **d**